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Classroom Access Checklist

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FOR THE GEN-ED TEACHER WELCOMING A DHH STUDENT

Classroom Access Checklist: Setup Guide for DHH Students in Gen Ed

A quick-reference checklist for the room a Deaf or hard-of-hearing (DHH) student joins — the itinerant in-service one-pager, reshaped as something you can actually check off. Students get to this point however they communicate: ASL, spoken language, a hearing device, or a combination. This list is about your classroom setup, not their hearing.

Before day one

- ☐ Seating gives the student a clear sightline to your face and to the board at the same time.
- ☐ Lighting checked — no window or bright light behind you when you speak (backlighting hides your face).
- ☐ If an interpreter, notetaker, or paraprofessional supports this student, you know where they'll sit and that the student can see both of you.
- ☐ You've confirmed which accommodations are on the IEP or 504 with the case manager or Teacher of the Deaf — not guessed at them.
- ☐ You know who to contact (ToD, case manager) with questions before the first day, not after something goes wrong.

Every day

- ☐ Face the class when you're speaking — not the board, not your screen.
- ☐ Repeat or rephrase a classmate's comment before you respond to it; the room only heard one side of that exchange.
- ☐ Captions are on for any video, no exceptions, checked before you press play.
- ☐ You check in privately about understanding, rather than asking "did you get that?" in front of peers.

Communication repair: when a message didn't land

Every classroom has moments where something doesn't get across the first time. What you do next matters more than what happened.

- ☐ **Rephrase it** — different words, not the same sentence louder.
- ☐ **Write the key words** on the board or hand them over on paper.
- ☐ **Confirm privately** that the repair worked, rather than assuming it did.

Common accommodations, at a glance

Accommodation	What it looks like in your room
Preferential seating	Near the front, with a clear line of sight to your face and the board — not necessarily “front row center” for every student.
Captions on video	Turned on before the video starts, every time, for the whole class.
Repeat / rephrase	You restate classmates' comments and directions before moving on, without being asked.
Visual backup	Key directions also written on the board or handed out, not spoken only.

About remote microphone / FM systems: some DHH students use a remote microphone or FM system as part of their supports. If this student does, their ToD or family will show you how it works and what your part is — we keep this checklist to the pedagogy side of the room. This resource is informational; follow your audiologist's and IEP team's guidance for anything about hearing technology.

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